

HTML5 – VIDEO AND AUDIO

HTML5 has drastically simplified the way multimedia content is addressed and referenced.

We'll explore what you can do with two of the most important HTML5 elements – audio and video. The audio and video elements add new media options to HTML5 applications that allow you to use audio and video without plugins and at the same time provides a common, integrated, and scriptable API.

Multimedia over web until today was delivered via plug-ins such as Adobe Flash, Silverlight and Windows media player. While these plug-ins worked well, there has never been a standard for showing audio/video on a web page. A user always had to download a plug-in to watch content.

One of the most exciting new features of HTML5 is the inclusion of the `<video>` and `<audio>` elements, which allow developers to include multimedia content directly in their pages without the need for any plugin-based solution.

Audio/Video Containers

An audio or video file is nothing more than a container file, very similar to a ZIP archive file that contains a number of files. Just like a ZIP file can contain any sort of file within it, video container formats only define how to store things within them, not what kinds of data are stored.